

Danh mục: general

Diabetes Testing

Diabetes Testing

May 15, 2024

Español

Key points

You'll need a blood sugar test to find out if you have prediabetes or diabetes.

Testing is simple, and results are usually available quickly.

Why get tested

Prediabetes and type 2 diabetes often don't have any symptoms

. (Type 1 diabetes is different—symptoms can develop quickly and can be severe.)

That's why people with any risk factors are urged to ask their doctor if they should be screened. Being screened means getting tested when you don't have any symptoms.

Catching prediabetes early can help people prevent or delay type 2 diabetes. Finding out they have type 2 diabetes—and taking action—can help people prevent or delay serious health complications.

Getting tested is simple and quick. Your blood will be drawn at your doctor's office or at a clinic so your blood sugar can be tested. Results are usually available quickly.

Keep Reading

Diabetes Risk Factors

When to get tested

Prediabetes and type 2 diabetes

Ask your doctor about getting tested for prediabetes or type 2 diabetes if you have any of the risk factors

. If you had your blood sugar tested at a health fair or pharmacy, follow up with your doctor. Your doctor may want to re-test you to make sure the results are accurate.

Type 1 diabetes

If your doctor thinks you have type 1 diabetes or you're at high risk

for type 1, your blood may also be tested for autoantibodies. These substances show your body is attacking itself and are often found with type 1 diabetes but not with type 2. Autoantibody testing can detect early stages of type 1 diabetes, which can be treated before symptoms and serious complications appear.

You may have your urine tested for ketones. Ketones are produced when your body burns fat for energy. Having ketones in your urine indicates you have type 1 diabetes instead of type 2.

Gestational diabetes

Gestational diabetes usually develops around the 24 week of pregnancy. You'll probably be tested between 24 and 28 weeks.

If you're at higher risk for gestational diabetes, your doctor may test you earlier. If your blood sugar is higher than normal early in your pregnancy, you may not have gestational diabetes. You may have type 1 or type 2 diabetes instead.

Types of tests

Tests for type 1 diabetes, type 2 diabetes, prediabetes, and gestational diabetes

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A1C test

A1C test

measures your average blood sugar level over the past 2 or 3 months.

Normal

: below 5.7%

Prediabetes

: 5.7–6.4%

Diabetes

: 6.5% or above

Fasting blood sugar test

This measures your blood sugar after an overnight fast (not eating).

Normal

: 99 mg/dL or below

Prediabetes

: 100–125 mg/dL

Diabetes

: 126 mg/dL or above

Glucose tolerance test

This measures your blood sugar before and after you drink a liquid that contains glucose. You'll fast (not eat) overnight before the test and have your blood drawn to measure your fasting blood sugar level. Then you'll drink the liquid and have your blood sugar level checked. These checks usually happen at 1 hour, 2 hours, and possibly 3 hours afterward.

At 2 hours:

Normal

: 140 mg/dL or below

Prediabetes

: 140–199 mg/dL

Diabetes

: 200 mg/dL or above

Random blood sugar test

This measures your blood sugar at the time you're tested. You can take this test at any time and don't need to fast (not eat) first.

Normal

: n/a

Prediabetes

: n/a

Diabetes

: 200 mg/dL or above

Autoantibody test

Type 1 diabetes is caused when your immune system creates autoantibodies (a type of immune cell) that destroy cells that make insulin in the pancreas. A simple blood test can be done to check for these diabetes-related autoantibodies.

Type 1 diabetes develops in three specific stages

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according to how many autoantibodies are present, whether blood sugar levels are normal, and if symptoms are present.

Tests for gestational diabetes

Glucose screening test

This measures your blood sugar at the time you're tested. You'll drink a liquid that contains glucose. Then, 1 hour later your blood will be drawn to check your blood sugar level. A normal result is 140 mg/dL or lower. If your level is higher than 140 mg/dL, you'll need to take a glucose tolerance test.

Glucose tolerance test

This measures your blood sugar before and after you drink a liquid that contains glucose. You'll fast (not eat) overnight before the test and have your blood drawn to measure your fasting blood sugar level. Then you'll drink the liquid and have your blood sugar level checked. These checks usually happen at 1 hour, 2 hours, and possibly 3 hours afterward. Results can differ depending on the size of the glucose drink and how often your blood sugar is tested.

Ask your doctor what your test results mean

After a diagnosis

If your results show you have type 1, type 2, or gestational diabetes, talk with your doctor about a detailed treatment plan. Your plan should include a referral to:

Diabetes self-management education and support services

An endocrinologist (a doctor who diagnoses and treats hormone-related conditions). In its early stages, type 1 diabetes can be treated to avoid or delay symptoms and serious complications.

A registered dietitian.

You'll also find out about

specific steps

you can take to be your healthiest no matter what type of diabetes you have.

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Sources

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